

TruScore Explainer: How Scoring Works (Simple Guide)

Change History



Version	Date	Changes
v1	Nov 20, 2025	Initial draft based on core pillars and public sources.
v2	Nov 22, 2025	Added geo-overrides, pet/household specifics; base to 15 for indie fairness.
v3	Nov 25, 2025	Incorporated sentiment/news in Care; clarified LCA blend and recall time-bounds (12mo).
v4	Nov 27, 2025	Removed geopolitics from Care; expanded certs with rationale; tightened Open (full=20, partial=10-15, none=0); GS1 future-proofing.
v5	Nov 28, 2025	Moved religious certs (e.g., Halal/Kosher) to user-choice modals; further tightened Open (full=15, partial=5-10, none=-5) to balance with base 15 and punish opacity.
Final	Nov 29, 2025	Cleaned for launch: No version diffs in body; final tweaks for virality and G20 sentiment alignment.

TruScore is a 0-100 rating split evenly into 4 pillars (25 pts each)—Body, Planet, Care,

Open. We use public sources like Nutri-Score for health, Eco-Score for eco, NOVA for processing, and OFF labels for transparency. Starts at 15 base per pillar (slightly positive neutral till bad). Global avg priority; local govt overrides OFF for relevance (e.g., USDA for US). No black-box—defensible, virality-focused (recalls shock shares). Data boost: FDA/CFIA/FSANZ for recalls/origins, X semantic for sentiment, user subs fill gaps (premium rewards). User prefs (e.g., vegan, keto, BDS, religious like Halal/Kosher) as toggle-able modal alerts only—no score impact.

Body Pillar: Safe for You (Health/Nutrition)

Starts at 15 (neutral till bad, per WHO). Covers nutrients, processing, additives—links to disease/gut issues (top X concern 2025).

- Base Score: Neutral 15 if no data.
- Nutri-Score Grade: A=25 (balanced) to E=5 (junk). Why? EU studies: A cuts heart risk 20%.
- NOVA Group: 1=+3 (whole foods), 3=-3, 4=-8 (ultra-processed, cap -10). Why? Studies: 4 hikes disease 50%.
- Additives/Risks: IARC Class 1=-10 (carcinogen), 2A=-5, 2B=-3 (cap -15). Why? WHO: 18% cancer risk.
- Allergens/Irritants: -5 per high-risk (cap -10, recall temp -5). Why? 15% affected, X hates hidden.
- Pet/Household: +5 compliant (AAFCO pet nutrition/EWG low-tox). Why? Pet obesity/tox chems up 20% 2025.

Planet Pillar: Good for Earth (Sustainability)

Starts at 15. Covers emissions, palm/deforestation, packaging—palm boycotts up 25% on X.

- Base Score: Neutral 15 if no data.

- Eco-Score Grade: A=25 (low impact) to E=5. Why? ADEME: A cuts emissions 50%.
LCA override: If local LCA (e.g., FSANZ/WWF metrics), blend final = $0.5 * \text{local_converted} + 0.5 * \text{global}$ for geo relevance.
- Palm/Deforestation: Non-sust=-8 (cap -10). Why? WWF: 50% forest loss.
- Packaging: Full recycle=+5, partial=+2. Why? Plastic disgust 30%.
- Origins: Missing/high-risk=-5 (cap -10). Why? Supply shocks 25% distrust.
- Pet/Household: +3 recyclable (EPA/EWG standards). Why? Pet waste/plastics pollution up 15%.

Care Pillar: Good for People & Animals (Ethics/Welfare)

Starts at 15. Covers certs, violations, recalls—boycotts/scandals (30% X impact).

- Base Score: Neutral 15 if no data.
- Certifications: Fairtrade +8 (holistic labor/env), Organic +7 (health/eco), Rainforest/UTZ +6 (deforest), MSC/ASC +6 (marine), RSPCA/Leaping Bunny/B Corp +5 (welfare/ethics), Cage-Free/Free-Range +4 (basic)—cap +15. Why? Tiered by breadth (studies: Fairtrade 20% poverty cut, lower for narrow).
- Violations/Cruelty: Minor=-5, major=-15 (cap -20). Why? PETA/HSUS: 50% disgust.
- Recalls: -10 temp if within last 12mo (FDA/CFIA/FSANZ). Why? Nestle spikes 15-25% virality; 12mo bound fades impact per studies.
- Sentiment/Negative News: -5 to -10 if active (X semantic >10k mentions last 6mo). Why? Real-time scandals drive 25% distrust—expires 6mo.
- Pet Specifics: +5 compliant (RSPCA pet welfare). Why? Pet cruelty up 20%.

Open Pillar: Transparent with You (Disclosure)

Starts at 15. Covers ingredients, hidden terms, origins—70% distrust hidden (X 2025).

- Base Score: Neutral 15 if no data.

- Ingredients Disclosure: Full=15, partial=5-10 (>80%=10, 50-80%=5), none=-5. Why? Trust killer—tightened to punish opacity without over-reward.
- Hidden Terms: 1-2=-10, >=3=-20 (cap -20 for parfum/aroma). Why? 50% disgust.
- Origins: No origin=-8, +5 GS1 complete (2027 2D for supplier/processing). Why? Geopolitics distrust 30%—GS1 future-proofs traceability.

↳ Compare TruScore to Yuka

↳ UI modal wireframes

↳ more concise bullets